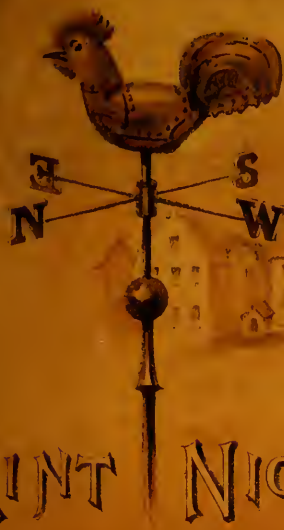


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THE
SAINT NICHOLAS SOCIETY
OF THE CITY OF
NEW YORK.

RECORD

OF THE

"VAN SPELJK"

DINNER

MAY 8th

1893.



FOUNDED
Feb. 28, 1835.

TIFFANY & CO. NEW YORK.



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PRESENTED BY

*Presented with the Compliments of the Saint Nicholas
Society of the City of New York.*

George G. De Witt,
Secretary,

88 Nassau Street.

Saint Nicholas Society
of the City of New York

Record of the
Dinner Given in Honor of the
Officers
of
H. N. M. Frigate "VAN SPEIJK"



8 MAY, 1893

HOTEL DE LOGEROT, NEW YORK

PUBLISHED BY THE SOCIETY

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Gift
Mrs. Julian James
1912

THE assemblage in the Port of New York, in the month of April, 1893, of a fleet representing the naval powers of the world, presented one of the most striking incidents of the Columbian celebration, and the international significance of the event renders it of historic importance. As an expression of the good-will and respect of other nations for this country, it was felt and appreciated by every citizen of the United States; but to the citizens of New York the presence in the fleet of a vessel representing the Dutch Government was of peculiar and personal interest. The course long since sailed by the "HALF MOON" was retraced by the "VAN SPEIJK," and the flag which discovered the Hudson once more floated over its waters. Tradition and affection alike prompted a cordial welcome to the representatives of the mother country whence came the founders of New Amsterdam, and upon the SAINT NICHOLAS SOCIETY devolved the duty and the honor of tendering that welcome.

At a Special Meeting of the Society, held on the twelfth day of April, 1893, it was determined

to give a Dinner to the Commandant and Officers of the "VAN SPEIJK," and the following committee of arrangements was appointed :

COMMITTEE.

FREDERIC J. DE PEYSTER,	CHAUNCEY M. DEPEW,
ROBERT G. REMSEN,	EDWARD COOPER,
STUYVESANT FISH,	HOWLAND PELL,
EDWARD KING,	EDWARD N. TAILER,
JAMES WILLIAM BEEKMAN,	ABRAHAM B. VALENTINE,
GEORGE G. DEWITT,	HENRY C. SWORDS,
GEORGE H. MCLEAN,	J. HOOKER HAMERSLEY,
AUSTEN G. FOX,	HENRY W. BIBBY,
FREDERIC GALLATIN,	PHILIP RHINELANDER,
WILLIAM JAY,	SMITH E. LANE,
ALFRED VAN SANTVOORD,	CHAS. A. SCHERMERHORN,
A. R. MACDONOUGH,	BANYER CLARKSON,
	<i>Treasurer.</i>
	<i>Secretary.</i>

STEWARDS.

CHARLES C. HAIGHT,	PHILIP SCHUYLER,
T. MATLACK CHEESMAN,	EDWARD DE P. LIVINGSTON,
JOHN B. PINE,	EUGENE VAN RENSSELAER.

Immediately upon the arrival of the "VAN SPEIJK" at Hampton Roads, the wishes of the Society were communicated to the Commandant

and Officers, and they having selected the eighth of May as the date best suited to their convenience, the following invitation was despatched :

NEW YORK, April 26, 1893.

To the Hon. W. A. ARRIENS,

Captain, Commandant of H. N. M. Frigate "VAN SPEIJK."

DEAR SIR:

The Saint Nicholas Society of the City of New York beg leave to congratulate you as Commandant of the Frigate "VAN SPEIJK," bearing the flag of the Netherlands, on your arrival at New York.

Descended from a common ancestry, and looking back with pride to the name and fame of the founders of our city, our Society hail with sincere satisfaction the appearance of your frigate on the waters of that Hudson which the same flag discovered and explored.

A committee of our Society is now charged to ask you and your officers to favor us with your company at the Hotel de Logerot, Fifth Avenue and Eighteenth Street, on Monday, the eighth of May, at seven o'clock, at a dinner which our members desire to give in honor of your arrival among us, and in testimony of our never-failing regard for the land which you represent.

With great consideration and respect,

Your obedient servants,

FREDERIC J. DE PEYSTER,

President and Chairman.

BANYER CLARKSON,

Secretary of the Committee,

15 West 45th Street, New York.

To this invitation the following reply was received :

May 1, 1893.

DEAR SIR:

Captain W. A. ARRIENS wishes me to inform you that he and the following officers will be very glad to have the honor to attend to the dinner you kindly invited us, on Monday, eighth of May.

Respectfully.

Your obedient servant,

A. J. KLEIJNENBERG,

Lt.-Adj.

(The list of officers is printed in full on pages 8 and 9.)

The Loving Cup.

Upon the publication of the notice of the dinner, much interest was manifested ; and it was at once proposed that the occasion be made further memorable by presenting to the "VAN SPEIJK" a loving cup. The response to the circular announcing this project was so generous as to enable the Committee to purchase a loving cup of silver, richly embossed, measuring fourteen and three-eighths inches in height, having a capacity of nine pints, and weighing seventy-five ounces, and, in addition, a pair of silver pitchers similar in style to the cup. Each piece was engraved with a suitable inscription, and the cup also bore the arms of the Netherlands and of the Society. The inscription upon the cup was as follows :

PRESENTED TO
H. N. M. S.S. VAN SPEIJK
BY THE
SAINT NICHOLAS SOCIETY
OF THE CITY OF NEW YORK,
AS A TOKEN OF THE GRATITUDE AND GOOD WILL
OF THE
NEW NETHERLANDS TO THE OLD NETHERLANDS.
NEW YORK. MAY VIII., MDCCCXCIII.

The cup and pitchers, standing on ebony pedestals, occupied a central place on the President's table at the dinner.

The Dinner.

The dinner in honor of the Commandant and Officers of H. N. M. S.S. "VAN SPEIJK" was given at the Hotel de Logerot on the evening of Monday, May eighth, 1893.

Frederic J. de Peyster, Esq., the President of the Society, presided, and the following named officers of the "VAN SPEIJK" were present as the guests of the Society :

Captain W. A. ARRIENS.

Commander B. DE GROOT.

Lieutenant H. W. L. OLIVIER.

Lieutenant S. F. NOLST FRENITE.

Lieutenant G. J. J. VERDAM.

Lieutenant J. A. KOOL.

Lieutenant A. J. KLEIJNENBERG.

Sub-Lieutenant K. W. SLUIS.

Sub-Lieutenant K. W. VAN DER CHIJS.

Sub-Lieutenant L. VAN VERRE.

Sub-Lieutenant A. N. VAN SANTEN.

Sub-Lieutenant J. R. VAN DER MANDELEN.

Sub-Lieutenant F. H. A. GREVE.

Sub-Lieutenant B. H. VAN MEERLANT.

Sub-Lieutenant H. C. STEFFELAAR.

Sub-Lieutenant L. G. P. MARCELLA.

Sub-Lieutenant P. M. A. BOGAERT.

Sub-Lieutenant W. F. PRINS.

Sub-Lieutenant L. U. COMMIJS.

Paymaster J. J. VAN DIEMEN.

Assistant Paymaster J. M. GRULLEMANS.

Surgeon J. VAN DER KOLK.

Surgeon VAN DER VOO.

Engineer J. VEGTEL.

Lieutenant of Marines J. M. ENTE VAN GILS.

Also the following named gentlemen, guests
of the Society :

THE BISHOP OF NEW YORK.

Hon. BENJAMIN F. TRACY, ex-Secretary of the
Navy.

Rear-Admiral BANCROFT GHERARDI, and two
staff officers.

Rear-Admiral A. E. H. BENHAM, and staff
officer.

Rear-Admiral RHIND.

Commodore HENRY ERBEN.

Rev. Dr. VANDEWATER.

JOHN R. PLANTEN, Esq., Consul-General of
the Netherlands.

J. WILLIAM BEEKMAN, Esq., President of the
Holland Society.

General JAMES M. VARNUM, President of the
Society of Colonial Wars.

AUGUSTUS R. MACDONOUGH, Esq., ex-Presi-
dent of the Society.

Also the following named gentlemen :

JOHN H. ABEEL, Jr., Esq.,	Rev. Dr. COE,
Dr. JAMES H. ANDERSON,	JOSEPH CORNELL, Esq.,
W. LORING ANDREWS, Esq.,	S. D. COYKENDALL, Esq.,
J. STORM APPLEBY, Esq.,	E. A. CRUIKSHANK, Esq.,
ERNEST AYRAULT, Esq.,	F. H. DAVIES, Esq.,
HENRY D. BABCOCK, Esq.,	JOHN W. A. DAVIS, Esq.,
AUSTIN P. BALDWIN, Esq.,	EDWARD F. DELANCEY, Esq.,
THEODORE M. BANTA, Esq.,	JOHNSTON DEPEYSTER, Esq.,
CHARLES T. BARNEY, Esq.,	EDWARD DEWITT, Esq.,
LEONARD F. BECKWITH, Esq.,	GEORGE G. DEWITT, Esq.,
HENRY R. BEEKMAN, Esq.,	WILLIAM G. DEWITT, Esq.,
Dr. JOHN N. BEEKMAN,	THEODORE DEWITT, Esq.,
RUSSELL BENEDICT, Esq.,	Dr. FRANCIS DELAFIELD,
HENRY W. BIBBY, Esq.,	EDWARD N. DICKERSON, Esq.,
GEORGE BLAGDEN, Esq.,	H. BLANCHARD DOMINICK,
WILLIAM A. BOYD, Esq.,	Esq.,
Hon. HENRY W. BOOKSTAVEN,	CORNELIUS DUBOIS, Esq.,
EDWARD S. BOGERT, Esq.,	WILLIAM A. DUBOIS, Esq.,
CHARLES BRAY, Esq.,	JOHN DUER, Esq.,
WILLIAM L. BROWER, Esq.,	EDWARD DUVIVIER, Esq.,
J. ADRIANCE BUSH, Esq.,	HERMAN LEROY EDGAR, Esq.,
JOSEPH BUSHNELL, Esq.,	JAMES J. FAYE, Esq.,
JOHN S. BUSSING, Esq.,	JAMES W. FELLOWS, Esq.,
CHARLES H. BUTLER, Esq.,	NICHOLAS FISH, Esq.,
MOTT J. CANNON, Esq.,	STUYVESANT FISH, Esq.,
JOHN A. CHAMBERS, Esq.,	HOWARD FLEMING, Esq.,
BANYER CLARKSON, Esq.,	W. HENRY FORMAN, Esq.,
Col. FLOYD CLARKSON,	ABBOTT FOSTER, Esq.,
Hon. A. T. CLEARWATER,	FREDERICK DE P. FOSTER, Esq.,

GIRAUD FOSTER, Esq.,	WILLIAM W. KIP, Esq.,
AUSTEN G. FOX, Esq.,	FRANCIS T. L. LANE, Esq.,
R. H. GALLATIN, Esq.,	P. VAN ZANDT LANE, Esq.,
FREDERIC GALLATIN, Esq.,	JOHN LAWRENCE, Esq.,
EDWARD N. GIBBS, Esq.,	MARSHALL C. LEFFERTS, Esq.,
HENRY E. GREGORY, Esq.,	EDWARD DEP. LIVINGSTON,
JOHN P. HAINES, Esq.,	Esq.,
J. HOOKER HAMERSLEY, Esq.,	Gen. JOHN T. LOCKMAN,
WILLIAM G. HAMILTON, Esq.,	RICHARD P. LOUNSBERY, Esq.,
HENRY P. HAVENS, Esq.,	W. B. LOCKWOOD, Esq.,
Rev. Dr. HOFFMAN,	WILLIAM E. LOWE, Esq.,
Dr. JOHN H. HINTON,	CLEMENT MARCH, Esq.,
Dr. JOSEPH J. HULL,	PETER MARIE, Esq.,
WILLIAM T. INNES, Esq.,	ALBERT MATHEWS, Esq.,
JOHN B. IRELAND, Esq.,	J. H. McCOON, Esq.,
CHARLES ISHAM, Esq.,	GEORGE H. McLEAN, Esq.,
Col. WILLIAM JAY,	JAMES McLEAN, Esq.,
F. P. JOHNSON, Esq.,	Hon. WARNER MILLER,
THEODORE P. JOHNSON, Esq.,	JAMES M. MONTGOMERY, Esq.,
WALTER R. T. JONES, Esq.,	CASIMIR DER. MOORE, Esq.,
Hon. CONRAD N. JORDAN,	D. SACKETT MOORE, Esq.,
Lieutenant S. S. JORDAN,	FORDHAM MORRIS, Esq.,
THOMAS D. JORDAN, Esq.,	CARLISLE NORWOOD, Esq.,
DAVID M. KELLOGG, Esq.,	LEWIS M. NORWOOD, Esq.,
HENRY KETALTAS, Esq.,	E. BENEDICT OAKLEY, Esq.,
Lieutenant KILBURN,	THOMAS I. OLCOTT, Esq.,
EDWARD KING, Esq.,	THOMAS L. OGDEN, Esq.,
JAMES G. KING, Esq.,	J. SEAVER PAGE, Esq.,
Hon. JOHN A. KING,	WALLACE F. PECK, Esq.,

HOWLAND PELL, Esq.,	EDWARD SCHELL, Esq.,
EDMUND H. PENFOLD, Esq.,	EDWARD H. SCHELL, Esq.,
WILLIAM H. PENFOLD, Esq.,	CHARLES A. SCHERMERHORN,
R. N. PERLEE, Esq.,	Esq.,
JOHN JAY PIERREPONT, Esq.,	E. A. SCHULTZE, Esq.,
JOHN B. PINE, Esq.,	W. WATTS SHERMAN, Esq.,
Dr. CHARLES T. POOR,	WILLIAM L. SKIDMORE, Esq.,
Flag-Lieutenant POTTER,	Dr. GOUVERNEUR M. SMITH,
JOHN V. L. PRUYN, Esq.,	Col. JACQUELIN SMITH,
J. HARSEN PURDY, Esq.,	ORISON B. SMITH, Esq.,
Dr. EDWARD QUINTARD,	PIERRE J. SMITH, Esq.,
EDWARD A. QUINTARD, Esq.,	HENRY STANTON, Esq.,
WILLIAM I. QUINTARD, Esq.,	WILLIAM R. STEWART, Esq.,
FRANK E. RANDALL, Esq.,	ROBERT STUYVESANT, Esq.,
HENRY S. RAPELYE, Esq.,	HENRY C. SWORDS, Esq.,
A. A. RAVEN, Esq.,	W. P. TABER, Esq.,
ROBERT G. REMSEN, Esq.,	EDWARD N. TAILER, Esq.,
T. J. OAKLEY RHINELANDER,	PAUL T. THEBAUD, Esq.,
Esq.,	HOWARD TOWNSEND, Esq.,
PHILIP RHINELANDER, Esq.,	HENRY G. TREVOR, Esq.,
J. HARSEN RHOADES, Esq.,	Dr. J. R. TRYON, U.S.N.,
BENJAMIN RICHARDS, Jr., Esq.,	HERBERT B. TURNER, Esq.,
JOHN L. RIKER, Esq.,	Prof. J. H. VAN AMRINGE,
WILLIAM J. RIKER, Esq.,	CORTLANDT S. VAN RENSSE-
HENRY S. ROKENBAUGH, Esq.,	LAER, Esq.,
HENRY SAMPSON, Esq.,	EUGENE VAN RENSSELAER,
ARTHUR B. SATTERLEE, Esq.,	Esq.,
EDWARD R. SATTERLEE, Esq.,	EUGENE VAN SANTVOORD,
GEORGE E. SCHANCK, Esq.,	Esq.,

ABRAHAM VAN SANTVOORD,	FREDERIC C. WAGNER, Esq.,
Esq.,	Col. ALFRED WAGSTAFF,
ALFRED VAN SANTVOORD,	TOWNSEND WANDELL, Esq.,
Esq.,	HENRY Y. WEMPLE, Esq.,
JOHN R. VANWORMER, Esq.,	EVERT JANSEN WENDELL, Esq.,
JACOB T. VAN WYCK, Esq.,	WILLIAM HULL WICKHAM,
Dr. JOHN VANDERPOEL,	Esq.,
A. B. VALENTINE, Esq.,	JOSEPH C. WILLETTS, Esq.,
Dr. MAUS R. VEDDER,	EDWARD J. WOOLSEY, Esq.,
GEORGE WADDINGTON, Esq.,	J. J. WYSONG, Esq.

Each officer of the "VAN SPEIJK" was presented with a memento of the dinner in the form of a badge, consisting of a gold cross-bar, bearing the name of the Society, to which was attached an orange ribbon, with the words "Welcome to the 'VAN SPEIJK.' New York, May 8th, 1893."

After having been presented to the President and introduced to the members of the Society, the guests were escorted to the dining hall, the trumpeter and attendants, in the livery of the Society, preceding, the Stewards being next in order, followed by the President escorting Captain Arriens, and the other officers and guests. The dining hall was decorated with the tri-color of the Netherlands alternating with the orange of the Society. A floral model of the "VAN SPEIJK" stood in the centre of the room, and the tables were adorned with tulips and smilax.

The following named gentlemen were seated at the President's table :

FREDERIC J. DE PEYSTER, President of the Society.

Captain ARRIENS, of the "VAN SPEIJK."

Commander DE GROOT, of the "VAN SPEIJK."

THE BISHOP OF NEW YORK.

Hon. BENJAMIN F. TRACY, ex-Secretary of the Navy.

Rear-Admiral BANCROFT GHERARDI.

Rear-Admiral A. E. H. BENHAM.

Rear-Admiral RHIND.

Commodore HENRY ERBEN.

Rev. Dean HOFFMAN.

Rev. Dr. VANDEWATER.

JOHN R. PLANTEN, Esq., Consul-General of the Netherlands.

J. WILLIAM BEEKMAN, Esq., President of the Holland Society.

General JAMES M. VARNUM, President of the Society of Colonial Wars.

AUGUSTUS R. MACDONOUGH, Esq., ex-President of the Society.

EDWARD KING, Esq., Second Vice-President of the Society.

The Rev. Dean Hoffman having pronounced a blessing, the following dinner was served :

Spijskaart.

Clams en coquille.

POTAGE.

Consommé De Ruyter.

HORS D'ŒUVRE.

Radis.

Tomates.

Olives.

Timbales à la Zuyder Zee.

POISSON.

Truite de Spuyten Duyvil, vert-pré.

Concombres.

Pommes Harlaem.

RELEVÉ.

Agneau de Printemps.

Petit pois aux laitues.

ENTRÉES.

Ris de veau, Van Tromp.

Haricots verts nouveaux.

Asperges en branches.

SORBET VAN SPEIJK.

RÔTI.

Pigeonneaux.

Salade de laitue.

Glaces de fantasie.

Fraises.

Petits fours.

Fromage.

Café.

Pipes.

Schnapps.

Tobacco.

CHABLIS.

IRROY BRUT.

PERRIER-JOUËT RESERVE.

AMONTILLADO.

LIQUEURS.

Presentation of the Cup.

During the dinner, and while the sorbet was being served, the President presented the loving cup and pitchers in the following terms :

“Captain Arriens, the gentlemen of this Society have long been desirous of proving, by more than mere words, their deep feeling for the old home of their fathers. They know how the news of Van Speijk’s splendid heroism was received in your storied land. They remember that your Parliament at once voted that : ‘So long as Holland is a nation, a vessel of the rank of a frigate shall always bear the name of Van Speijk.’ We believe that your glorious little land, which has preserved her independence against all odds for more than three centuries, will be able to maintain it for centuries yet to come. No matter how long the life of your ship may be, Captain Arriens, we know that she is destined to be followed by an endless succession of Van Speijks. As a slight token, therefore, of the gratitude, admiration and love which the children of Saint Nicholas feel for the dear old

Fatherland, I commit to your keeping this cup and these pitchers, which we give to the frigate bearing the immortal name of Van Speijk."

The President, after drinking from the cup, handed it to Captain Arriens, who accepted the gift on behalf of the "VAN SPEIJK" in a few suitable remarks, and the cup was then passed around the tables until each person present had drunk the toast to the "VAN SPEIJK."

At the conclusion of the dinner, the Weather-Cock was borne into the room preceded by the Society's trumpeter and escorted by the Stewards, and was placed upon the President's table. The National Air of the Netherlands was then sung by all present.

Wien Neerlandsch Bloed.

(DUTCH NATIONAL SONG.)

1. Let him in whom old Dutch blood flows,
Untainted, free and strong,
Whose heart for Home and country glows,
Now join us in our song;
Let him with us lift up his voice,
And sing in patriot band,
The song at which all hearts rejoice,
For Home and Fatherland,
For Home and Fatherland.

2. We brothers, true unto a man,
 Will sing the old song yet;
 Away with him whoever can
 His Home or land forget!
 A human heart glow'd in him ne'er,
 We turn from him our hand,
 Who callous hears the song and pray'r
 For Home and Fatherland,
 For Home and Fatherland.

3. Preserve, oh God, the dear old ground
 Thou to our fathers gave;
 The land where they a cradle found,
 And where they found a grave.
 We call, oh God, to Thee on high,
 As near death's door we stand,
 Oh! safety, blessing, is our cry,
 For Home and Fatherland,
 For Home and Fatherland.

4. Loud ring through all rejoicing here,
 Our pray'r, oh Lord, to Thee,
 Preserve our Home, our friends so dear,
 Our Holland, great and free.
 From youth thro' life be this our song,
 Till near death's door we stand:
 Oh, God, preserve our Holland long,
 Our Home and Fatherland,
 Our Home and Fatherland.

Toasts.

THE PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES.

THE QUEEN OF THE NETHERLANDS.

OUR GUESTS.

THE LAND OF OUR ANCESTORS AND THE FOUND-
ERS OF OUR CITY.

Holland : She created a State amid the storms of ocean ; she defended it against the fury of civil and religious tyrants ; she transplanted its might and its virtues to the New World.

THE "HALF MOON"—THE "PRINCE OF ORANGE"
—THE "VAN SPEIJK."

One bore the daring discoverer, Hudson ; one brought kindly greetings from our kindred across the sea ; one immortalizes an act of splendid heroism.

*" Illi robur et aes triplex
" Circa pectus erat."*

THE ARMY AND NAVY OF THE UNITED STATES.

THE NAVY OF THE NETHERLANDS.

The just pride of that amphibious race which foiled Cæsar in its Batavian marshes, drowned

out the Spaniards before Leyden, and sent its conquering Admirals through English seas. May we never meet it but in peace.

NEW AMSTERDAM.

Well governed when the Dutch governed it; to be again well governed when their descendants resume its control.

President's Address.

GENTLEMEN : We are assembled here to-night to do honor to our guests, Captain Arriens of the "VAN SPEIJK" and his gallant officers, as the representatives of the dear old Fatherland.

As I look around this grand hall to-night, blazing with our ancestral orange ; at the dear old flag of the Netherlands ; at these uniforms worn by the successors of Von Tromp, De Ruyter and Van Speijk, your honest Knickerbocker faces carry me away from the present. It seems as though the mists of two hundred and thirty years had rolled away ; it seems as if we were once more under the paternal rule of Peter Stuyvesant. The tri-color still floats over us, and De Ruyter rides triumphant on the seas.

I almost expect to see, at any moment, that door open and the grand old Governor come stomping through the room with his wooden leg to take his seat at my side and do his part in welcoming our guests. The days of New Amsterdam, of Stuyvesant and De Ruyter, have gone forever, yet we never forget that it was Holland which planted the acorn that has developed into so mighty a tree. If the Greeks

and the Romans were right, if Fortune be indeed a Goddess, if nothing succeeds like success, then certainly the founders of New Amsterdam were the most fortunate of men; for the enterprise they started is the greatest success in history. The little New Amsterdam of De Ruyter's day has become the Rome of the New World. Yes, with a trade which Carthage could never have dreamt of; with a mental activity and energy and a love of the beautiful worthy of Athens itself, and the wealth, splendor and power of Rome; our New York is at once the Carthage, the Athens and the Rome of the New World rolled into one.

We believe, gentlemen, that the city has succeeded in no small degree because of the high, broad, bold spirit of its founders. Even sixty years ago the city had grown so great that the Knickerbocker was lost in the immense city which his fathers founded. It was necessary to organize this Society even then as the rallying point for historic New York. It is not exclusively a Batavian society. Here historic New York is honored; and, as the children of the Netherlands are the oldest New Yorkers, they naturally get a warm place at the table of Saint Nicholas. Yet blood has little to do with it—all here unite in their gratitude, admiration and affection for the glorious little land of dykes

and dams. Our great city boasts many excellent societies, useful in various fields. All honor to them! But as a social force there is no society in the New World which can compare with our time-honored organization.

Forty-one years ago this very month, our fathers entertained the officers of the Frigate "PRINZ VAN ORANGE" with the same hearty good-will that we feel towards you to-night. We feel as they felt, because the lapse of more than two centuries has not obliterated our love for the Fatherland. We welcome you to-night, Captain Arriens, and your gallant officers, as our fathers welcomed the officers of the "PRINZ VAN ORANGE" in the year of grace 1852.

I am reminded that among those who are with us here to-night is our charming friend Macdonough, son of the hero who won the battle of Lake Champlain: thus one of the children of Saint Nicholas who welcomed the officers of the "PRINCE OF ORANGE" has lived to welcome the officers of the "VAN SPEIJK."

If history teaches any one lesson with peculiar force, it is that its most brilliant pages have been contributed, not by giant empires, but by diminutive States like Palestine and Greece, the storied republics of mediæval Italy, and this glorious Fatherland of ours. Glory is the child not of quantity, but of quality. It is not the

land which makes the people, but the people the land. Judge, then, what must have been the force of that people who raised a mere sand bank in the German Ocean for one century to the rank of the first commercial power in the world; and which has kept that mere sand bank for three centuries the richest State on the Continent of Europe.

The sails of Holland whitened every sea, when Genoa and Venice were tottering to their fall, before the might of England arose. The Hollanders planted on the foggy shores of the Zuyder Zee an art not less splendid than that which developed on any shore of the Mediterranean, except in classic Greece alone. The first scholar of Europe was Erasmus of Rotterdam; the father of all sound political economy, and that my friend Admiral Gherardi will admit, was the good Dutchman Grotius. Gentlemen, when Holland realized that the pen was but a poor instrument to preserve thought, she presented mankind with the printing press; and thought became immortal. When Gallileo longed to explore the abysses of space, and study the stars, he was stayed; there were no means of traversing space and reaching the stars until the genius of a Hollander invented the telescope, and his work was made easy; and, to teach that the wonders of the vast are not more

startling than those of the little, she gave man at the same time the microscope as well.

Our Fatherland, gentlemen, was distinguished for her devotion to the cause of civil and religious freedom. The pages of her history afford as bright and shining examples of heroism as any which even Greece and Rome can boast. The bead roll of her great naval heroes, blazing with such illustrious names as Van Tromp, De Ruyter and Van Speijk, will be remembered while history is studied. The defense of such towns as Haarlem, Alkmar, Leyden, not by trained sailors and soldiers, but by men, women and little children, who suffered and died for the Fatherland, is the noblest story of modern times ; and every drop of blood in my body thrills through my veins with pride when I remember that on two occasions, when the soil of the Netherlands was overrun by innumerable and resistless hordes, this heroic people tore down their dykes and gave back their soil to the ocean rather than have it trampled by the foot of the foe.

Above all, Captain ; above all, gentlemen, we New Yorkers hold that the dearest claim that Holland has, the one that in the long run will fill the greatest space in history, is that she is the motherland of our Imperial City of this Empire State, and of the great Commonwealth of New Jersey across the Hudson.

All references to New Jersey are looked upon as comic. New Jersey has her faults, but there is a future before that Commonwealth. She has elements of greatness; and remember, it is very magnanimous for me to say so, for you all know that I am a New Yorker of New Yorkers. Holland has still another claim, not only on us New Yorkers, but on America as well. My friend Admiral Gherardi is prepared to give——

(Mr. De Peyster was interrupted by three cheers given for Admiral Gherardi.)

Admiral Gherardi says I am quite right. For the first time in my life I feel satisfied. His approval is sanction, indeed. Gentlemen, as I say, Holland has another claim, and a broad claim, on the sympathies of America. When unwise England banished the noble pilgrims, they found a kind foster-mother in Holland. There they learned a nobler civilization, and the real meaning, Admiral Gherardi and gentlemen, of civil and religious liberty. Even Joseph H. Choate admits this. I have heard him concede it twenty times, and he never would have conceded it if there were room for doubt. Holland, then, is the mother of New York and New Jersey, the blood-mother, and the foster-mother of the six New England States as well. Holland made her declaration of independence and formed her Union of Independent States two

hundred years before our Declaration of Independence and our Union was formed. She was the model ; and in the main it was on the lines of that Declaration of Independence and of that Union that our forefathers founded and built this great Republic. Holland is really and truly the mother of the United States of to-day.

Captain Arriens, with all this load of obligation from Americans to Holland, it is no wonder that we welcome you and your gallant officers as brothers at a brother's board. No one who wears your glorious uniform should ever feel himself a stranger on the soil of our Manhattan ; for this mighty city, with all its success and all its magnificence, is but a monument to the genius of your native land.

The President then announced the toasts :

THE PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES.

THE QUEEN OF THE NETHERLANDS.

The flags of the respective nations suspended over the President's table were dipped at the appropriate moment by an officer of the "VAN SPEIJK" and an officer of the "PHILADELPHIA," while the toasts were drunk.

Our Guests.

RESPONSE BY CAPTAIN ARRIENS :

GENTLEMEN : Scarcely had our frigate come into American waters and dropped her anchor in Hampton Roads on the 17th of April, when my officers and I received a great number of invitations both from official and private sources ; one of those that we received first was that of this Society. I feel myself very much honored to have once more the opportunity of assuring you all how highly we appreciate the extremely hearty and kindly reception which we have met with in New York. I express to all of you our most sincere thanks for all the kindness and friendship which has been shown to us. I wish to say that it was a very courteous act on the part of your honorable Society to offer to me and my ship such a splendid souvenir. At such a great distance from our dearly beloved country it is a great pleasure for us to mix and dwell among the members of your distinguished Saint Nicholas Society, who, as your much-esteemed President has said, must always look back with pride upon the mother and founder of this city. My officers and I think it is a great

favor for us all, and a great honor to have had the opportunity of personally observing how much you all stand to the memory of our forefathers. Proud as you are of that, I believe that you may all be justly proud of your forefathers in this country for all that was done by them in regard to the arts, sciences and industries. The imposing manner in which your country has celebrated the fourth centennial of the discovery of the New World by that illustrious admiral Columbus, has been a great credit to you and a great success.

The fact that such a great number of men-of-war ships have been assembled in your waters has been a notable one; fourteen men-of-war from whose masts float your stars and stripes; fourteen men-of-war of the most modern appliances; that this splendid fleet has been throughout the review under the command of so distinguished an Admiral as Admiral Gherardi, of your American Navy; this event, I say, is one of which you can be in the highest degree proud. As far as I know, it has never happened before all over the world. I assure you how deeply we are all touched by your kindness and friendship during our stay in your city. The recollection of the pleasure which you have afforded us will accompany us everywhere, and this souvenir will always remind

us of the friendship that you have shown us. While I and my officers ask you to remember us all with your kind wishes, I finish by proposing the prosperity of the distinguished Saint Nicholas Society of the United States of America.

The Land of Our Ancestors and the Founders of Our City.

RESPONSE BY THE CHAPLAIN OF THE SOCIETY,
THE RT. REV. BISHOP POTTER :

I am not in the habit of reducing a congregation to silence in that way (the gentleman alluded to the emphatic manner in which the Chairman enforced order).

I confess after your eloquent and exhaustive remarks that I am reminded of a painting which I think belonged in the famous gallery of Amsterdam representing what is known as Paul Potter's Bull. That picture, as you will remember, was loaned to the great Exposition of 1876 in Philadelphia. Somebody standing behind a bucolic crowd, who were studying the picture, heard a man say to his wife, as he pointed to a figure in the group which is partly hidden by a tree, "That is Potter hiding behind the tree." I feel, I confess, like retreating behind a tree, as the President, having assigned to me this distinctly historic toast, proceeded himself to say everything in regard to the history of Holland which needed to be said on this occasion. That is the characteristic generosity of himself. No-

body who has suffered kindness at his hands in the reunions of this Society can be otherwise than satisfied of his abundant capacity to make all the speeches of the occasion. And yet I think I may venture to remind him and my brethren of this Society, that this occasion has, at any rate, one rare and prominent distinction. It is a festivity—notwithstanding what has been said with reference to Admiral Gherardi, who has discreetly retired—it is an occasion absolutely without the element of scepticism. If you will reflect a moment you must realize, I think, that that element is necessarily a very large factor in all the festivities of this Columbian Celebration. We are told that it was Columbus that discovered America ; that statement is no sooner made than we are reminded of the fact that in 1135, as there are distinct evidences, the Norsemen came to this country, and traces of their settlements still remain. That still further back than that, in the year of our Lord one thousand and one, Lief and Bjorg crossed over to this country from Iceland, settled in Rhode Island and built the old mill, which is conclusive and irrefutable evidence, in spite of the scepticisms, of the presence of Icelanders on these shores nearly nine hundred years ago.

I had supposed until this morning that these two incidents in our early history sufficiently

impugned the claim of Columbus to have discovered America. But this very day in one of our ingenious and brilliant journals I discovered a communication, whose character I sufficiently indicate when I say it was signed by a gentleman who called himself O'Shea, which stated in the most positive and unhesitating manner that America was discovered in the Sixth Century by an Irishman from the town of Tralee, in the County Kerry, St. Branden by name, who spent some ten years on the ocean, and during those years landed on these shores. We shall read to-morrow morning that it was with considerable endeavor of self-restraint that when the other day Mayor Gilroy received the Duke Veragua at the hotel in Fifth Avenue, he restrained himself from challenging that gentleman's claim to represent the descendants of those who discovered America; and that it was a modesty peculiarly his own that prevented him from stating to whom that honor belonged.

But the charm of this evening, as I began, is that, in contrast with preceding festivities, no element of scepticism enters here. You have not exaggerated, Mr. Chairman, in the language which you have used (that is very unusual praise for me to be able to give you); you have not exaggerated the indebtedness of this country to Holland. Your words were received, I grieve

to say, with derision by Admiral Gherardi. But, gentlemen of the Saint Nicholas Society, and Captain Arriens, they were simply, absolutely and profoundly true.

There are two things that go to make a union great. The first the men, and then the institutions, out of which both men and nations are made. Whatever we owe to other lands, whatever may be our indebtedness to the country whose tongue we speak, there is, and you are right in affirming it, absolutely no question that the institutions which are ours to-day are derived supremely and prominently from the Motherland of Holland. She it was who taught the world how to govern her people by a republican form of government. She it was, as you have justly observed, who for the first time in, at any rate, some fifteen centuries, gave back to the world the great and precious principle of religious liberty. She it was, a most interesting fact, singularly overlooked in historic studies, who reintroduced for the first time since one hundred and thirty-nine years before Christ the use of the ballot in determining the choice of those officers in towns and in cities and in States by whom she should be governed. In the old town called Emden, just across the border from Holland—in Hanover, it is true, but settled by the Dutch people—there was

held the first election by ballot of which there is any account in connection with municipal history, until you go back for nearly two hundred years before Christ to the Roman Republic ; and, gentlemen, when those burghers arose and cast their ballots in the vase that received them, on that day they spoke the first clear, unequivocal words in the direction of this great principle of self-government, on which, after all, as the great corner-stone, the liberties of this land will forever depend.

And when, still further, you take up the history of that illustrious country and put it beside our own, nothing is more significant and interesting than the way in which the influence of Dutch institutions and Dutch ideas of government appear and re-appear all along this Atlantic Coast. It is within the bounds of modesty, I maintain, Mr. President, to claim for Holland that she taught the States on the seacoast how to govern themselves. She set us the example of government such as was illustrated in Connecticut under the leadership of men like Davenport, Mason and Gardner, a type which, step by step, repeated itself, until to-day it is one law and one principle of government from the Atlantic to the Pacific.

We follow out this line and we come to Pennsylvania, to Penn the Quaker ; yes, a Quaker ;

but where did the Quaker Penn get his ideas, those great ideas on which he founded the little Republic of Pennsylvania? The mother of Penn was a Dutch woman; it was from her breasts that Penn drew first that milk of liberty, of justice and of equity which made his wise and broad rule an example for all time. I might repeat this story to the end of the chapter. I might trace in our Senate and House of Representatives, in our common school system, in the form of the city government of our early New York, those great ideas which are the germs of the civic institutions in which the form and outline of this fair Republic was cast.

And so, gentlemen, in the presence of these facts one comes here to-night with a sense of profound thankfulness and joy that it is given to him to be here in the company of Captain Arriens, and those other honored guests who wear the noble uniform of Holland, and who sit about us here to-night, and to say to them what we owe to the mother in whose womb we took on the outlines of those Republican Institutions which are the glory of our land to-day.

The "Half Moon"—The "Prince of Orange"—The
"Van Speijk."

RESPONSE BY THE REV. DR. VANDEWATER :

GENTLEMEN : Judging from some of the remarks which I have heard in my vicinity, I consider that it will be a favor to translate this motto, which is not Dutch. The motto is appended by the one who so admirably prepared the toast, and it became the key to my interpretation of the sentiment. Fortunately, I had memory sufficient to recall the ode of Horace, and to translate it. I remember very well translating it first by the assistance of a small horse. This is the translation : "Oak with a triple breast-plate around the breast of him." If that is not a good translation there is nobody here to correct me.

It has so happened that our mother Holland has had such implicit confidence in the virtues and powers of her sons that notwithstanding many years have passed since first she gave us birth she has officially visited our shores but three times. The first occasion is a marked epoch in our great and rapidly developing history. The first we knew of the Dutch was the

visit of the "HALF MOON" in 1609, when Henry Hudson, an English navigator, failing to find the sympathy and support that he sought in England, found in a country that had recently acquired its own independence a readiness to give him both. It is a singular fact that our best product in this great country comes from the union of two great nationalities—England and Holland. We need never dispute which is the greater, since England's greatness is primarily Dutch virtue. The truth lies in the fact that we are the product of both, of England and of the country we filially love, and whose representatives are here to-night. Let us remember that in every great epoch of our history we have received the benediction from the union of these two great nations, the English and the Dutch. Only in the remembrance of that fact can we fully recognize our debt to the Dutch, and the glorious fruitage we have from a good father marrying a good mother. Even Omnipotence could not provide for the human race until He had taken from the side of His first creation that which was next to the best which He had first made. Join to Dutch ideas and valor, the English spirit of appropriating everything good and making it its own, and you have as a result, America and Freedom. In 1609 the "HALF MOON" came

to these waters ; a Dutch ship, sent by Dutch money, with Dutch patronage, armed by a daring and skillful navigator, Henry Hudson, an Englishman, who knew enough, when he could not find what he wanted at home, to go somewhere else to get it. He went to Holland. We are indebted to the Dutch, then, not only for the discovery of that magnificent river, the Hudson, which, like a silver thread, winds its way among our magnificent hills, reminding us of the river that flowed from the throne and made glad the City of God, but for all these wonderful Dutch trading settlements between New York and Albany, which have given us the best and grandest elements which make up what we call American commerce and civilization.

This daring discoverer having wended his way up the Hudson River to Albany, and planted Dutch settlements along that river, went back to his home, and the next year started on another voyage of discovery, resulting in the bay which to-day bears his name ; and not only his name but his body. During a scurvy plague Hudson was cast overboard by sailors, who estimated all too little the qualities of a great man, and discovering that no longer was he of use to them, threw him into the water, which, bearing the honored name of Hudson's Bay, is Hudson's grave and monument.

So much for the first Dutch ship that landed in these waters. Many years passed by, during which time Dutchmen settled on these shores, Dutchmen ruled, Dutchmen here were happy, Dutchmen founded all those glorious customs and institutions which we count to-day our greatest heritage. In the course of time, with a liberality which is the characteristic of the Dutch, when they found a nation willing to take up the reins of government and give them all that they wanted, without the burden of the care of it, the Dutch relinquished to the English, in 1664, the government of New Amsterdam, which then became New York. It is strange indeed that notwithstanding all that the Dutch have done for us, and the pride we have always taken in Holland, that a ship of the Dutch government never again parted these waters until as late as 1852. In the coming of the Dutch man-of-war the "PRINCE OF ORANGE" to these shores in 1852 we touch that which is connected chiefly with this Saint Nicholas Society. We know from experience that there is no history in any of our Public Libraries that tells of the important visit to these shores of that second Dutch ship, which was the first ship of Holland to appear in these waters in over one hundred and eighty years, the "PRINCE OF ORANGE." She bore to these shores Prince Hendrick, the

brother of the then reigning King, William III., and through him brought kindly greetings to us from our kindred across the seas. To minister somewhat to our pride as members of the Saint Nicholas Society, and to show what has been the amazing increase in this metropolitan city, let me tell you that in 1852, your fathers, your ancestors, most of whom are dead, sat around a table in the then best dining-room that could be procured in New York City, that of the Astor House, with the tri-color and with the United States flag decorating the room, and with the visiting Prince as their guest. Together the flags waved over the head of Ogden Hoffmann, who presided. On that occasion was heard the illustrious voice of that magnificent man, the greatest statesman orator, from Massachusetts, Daniel Webster. He spoke to the toast, "The influence of the Dutch on the institutions and Constitution of the United States." Great enthusiasm prevailed, and the dinner, with its speeches, created at the time the topic of public thought and private conversation throughout the town.

Forty-one years have passed, and now, on a great historical occasion, the occasion which celebrates the discovery of this marvelous country by Christopher Columbus, the ships of the world meet in our harbor. This is our feast in perpetuation of that of our fathers. To most

of us who are lineal descendants of the Dutchmen who have continuously lived in this city since the latter part of the seventeenth century, there is no ship, of all that now adorn our Hudson, that appeals so to our sympathies, there is none that seems to us so great, not measuring its size, but considering its historic importance, as that Dutch war ship the "VAN SPEIJK." Dutchmen, of all others, understand that they should not judge the virtues of anything by its immensity. Rome was but a hamlet compared with modern cities, yet Rome gave to the world its ideas of legislation and civilization. Athens was a village, yet Athens gave us our love of art and almost all that we know of culture and refinement. Holland is not as large as the State of New York, but Holland has given us not only that which is excellent in New York City itself, but the influence that has gone beyond to the Empire State, and further still, throughout the United States, to make all that is good and glorious in this land primarily and essentially Dutch. We look to your ship, sir, (turning to Capt. Arriens), not as the largest in the fleet, but representing principles the largest in beneficent results, which the country that sent it has bestowed upon the world.

When we think of that ship, we are poor Dutchmen indeed, if we cannot give thought for

one moment to the daring heroism which made the name of the ship immortal. In 1830, in the Belgic revolution, the young lieutenant Van Speijk, who was educated by the charity of Holland in an orphan school of Amsterdam, stood on the stern of his ship, which had parted its moorings the night before and had grounded north of the Commercial Basin at Antwerp. When he saw the Belgic volunteers come to the shore, and thought he heard their chief demand that the flag of Holland should be hauled down, he answered "Wait a moment until I go below." There, with a heroism that was as remarkable as it was essentially Dutch, he put his cigar to the powder magazine; and then, in the true Dutch spirit of reverence to his God, as he departed this life, knelt on his knees and but for a moment prayed; in an instant the whole ship with all on board and many also on land were blown up rather than that the flag of Holland should be sullied and the ship surrendered to the enemy. No wonder a public monument was erected to the memory of the gallant commander: no wonder that the King ordered that from that day there should be a warship forever flying the flag of Holland and bearing the name of "VAN SPEIJK."

So, gentlemen, these three ships visiting our waters at different times in nearly 300 years,

commemorate three epochs in our history; first, our birth, then, our younger manhood, and then, I will not say our old age, but to-day these gallant officers of the "VAN SPEIJK" visit our waters and witness our stronger middle life.

It is well known that at a critical period of her history, when England failed to find in all her realm an Englishman fit to rule her, she sent across the waters for a Dutchman to come and reign. William, "of glorious, pious and immortal memory," crossed the sea and stood in Westminster Hall, where was read to him the charter of liberties. When asked if by these principles he would reign, the Dutchman put his hand on the hilt of his sword, and said, in the presence of all the nobles, "I will maintain." Similarly, we New Yorkers say that the descendants of the gallant Dutch who settled this city, who gave us the best we have, who put into our blood the best elements of our American civilization, are ready to-night, surrounded here by the orange, the tri-color and the United States flag, remembering all that Holland has been to us, to put our hands to the imaginary hilts of our swords, and swear, in the presence of these Dutch nobles, "We will maintain." So far as we can, remembering the rock whence we were hewn, we will be loyal to our ancestry and perpetuate their virtues.

There seems to have been something more than human foresight in the arrangement which gives to us our national ensign. The tri-color of the Dutch has been most appropriately incorporated into the flag of our dear country. I beg you, gentlemen and officers of the "VAN SPEIJK," to report this back to your government; we have taken your three bars; your red, of devotion to duty unto death; your white, of purity of laws and of morals; your blue, of steadfastness and fixity of purpose; and we have added to these bars forty-four brilliant, lustrous stars; so that to-day we spread the banner of the United States to your glory as well as to ours. That banner is a greeting of New Netherlands to Old Netherlands. We praise Holland, and bless God that to-day we unfurl the banner of this country and see its folds resting upon two oceans, waving over fifty millions of men, and compassing a Hemisphere. Long may that banner wave!

THE PRESIDENT: The next toast is, "The Army and Navy of the United States." Gentlemen, the army and navy of the United States are well worthy of your quiet consideration. We have done our fair share so far in expressing our loyalty to the Fatherland. The army and navy of the United States need no eulogium

from me. They have a long history of glory behind them. The last, or most recent, defeat of the navy, is that of our friend, Admiral Gherardi. He was the doubting Thomas until about the end of my speech; and then he said he regretted that his name was not Stuyvesant. It would have been a great privilege to him to be born in New York, of good Dutch lineage; he said, that it was not his fault. In the meanwhile, I ask for a glorious response in the honor of the navy; that navy that has embraced one of the three greatest sailors in the history of the world; the three commanders on whom historians are agreed: De Ruyter, the Dutchman, Nelson, the Englishman, and our own glorious Farragut. I will ask Mr. Secretary Tracy to respond to that glorious toast.

The Army and Navy of the United States.

RESPONSE BY THE HON. BENJAMIN F. TRACY :

In speaking to the toast of the army and navy of the United States, I shall call you back for one moment from the ancient glories of this city under the great nation by which it was founded, to a realization of the fact that we are really Americans, and believe, above all things, in the United States of to-day and in all its institutions. The army and navy of the United States are living in the present as well as in the past, and it is not of their historical aspect that I would speak to-night. The history of the army and navy of the United States is familiar to you all. Our great commanders need no praise from me, nor shall I attempt any. I feel sure, from the recent events that have been taking place in our harbor, that you desire to hear of the present navy of the United States, rather than of that of the past, and it is of the recent progress that has been made in the reconstruction of our navy that I feel impelled to speak.

Ten years ago the construction of a modern

man-of-war was an unknown art in the United States. Few believed that we could build the great marine engines necessary to drive these monsters of destruction through the sea. Some of our best-informed people believed that it would not be possible to organize a force of mechanics and artisans that would be equal to the construction of these engines in the next ten or fifteen years. Such was the prevailing belief in 1883, when the first modern war vessels of this country were authorized—the “Boston,” the “Atlanta,” the “Chicago” and the “Dolphin.” In 1889 the navy of the United States, so far as completed and commissioned modern ships were concerned, still consisted of only the “Atlanta,” the “Boston” and the “Dolphin.” The “Chicago” was substantially completed on the 4th of March, 1889, and so was the “Yorktown,” but neither of them had been put in commission. When all of the ships that had at that date been authorized should have been constructed, the United States ranked as the thirteenth naval power in the world. When all the ships that are now authorized, and are in course of construction, are completed, the United States will rank as the fifth naval power. She has surpassed even Germany, and stands now, or will when our ships are completed, next to Italy, among the naval powers of the earth.

It is undoubtedly true that great progress has been made in the construction of our ships, and in all branches that go to make up a naval force. There are now authorized and in the process of construction, with those already completed, forty-four ships, and in type, ship for ship, I think I say nothing more than will be recognized by all experts who have given attention to the subject, our ships are the equal of any ships in the world. And, in fact, if I were inclined to boast, I should say that, ship for ship, they surpass any ships of any other nation. The best illustration that I can give you of that is a comparison between the "Blake" and the "New York." They are of about the same size. The "Blake" and the "Blenheim" were intended by England three or four years ago to be the greatest cruisers that had yet been constructed by any nation. The "New York" followed soon after; she is now completed and about to have her trial trip, and it is much to be regretted that she could not have been present at this Naval Review. The "New York," although she is a thousand tons less in displacement than the "Blake," I think will be conceded by all to be greatly her superior. She has a much heavier armament than the "Blake." Her guns are protected by ten inches of steel turrets, while the guns of the "Blake" are open

upon her deck. The sides of the "Blake" are entirely unprotected, while the "New York" has four-inch steel armor on her sides, amply sufficient to protect her from all rapid-fire guns. She has a greater coal endurance, and I venture to predict that she will be a faster ship. In all important respects, therefore, the "New York" must be admitted to be the "Blake's" superior.

Then, we have another ship that surpasses anything of her type that has ever yet been constructed. In fact, there is no navy in the world that has a ship that compares with the "Columbia" for certain features. She has a displacement of 7,500 tons and is designed as a commerce destroyer, pure and simple. She is not intended to fight, even with ships of her class; but she is intended to prey upon the commerce of any commercial adversary. She will, I think, beyond doubt, be the fastest man-of-war that has yet been constructed. It was upon her that the first experiment was made of the triple screw. That was an experiment; when it was determined to place triple screws upon our ships, she was the only large ship upon which any such experiment had been attempted. And yet the Germans, at that time about to begin the construction of the "Empress Augusta," that is now in your harbor, changed her plans, after they learned our plans in reference to the "Columbia," and put on

triple screws. She has proved a great success ; and the only experimental feature of the "Columbia" has been fully justified by the results achieved by the German cruiser now anchored in the North River. But the great speed of the American vessel, and her enormous coal endurance, far surpass those of any other man-of-war. She can steam from New York to San Francisco without recoaling.

We have also a sister ship of the "Columbia," the "Minneapolis," likewise under construction, which will give us two vessels of that particular class. Then we have our battle ships. Of those great engines of maritime warfare we have four now under construction, the "Indiana," the "Massachusetts," the "Oregon," and the "Iowa." These ships are built to fight. They are pure fighting machines, and are designed to protect the coasts and harbors of the United States. And all experts, I think, will agree that these ships of 10,200 tons displacement are equal in offensive and defensive power, if they are not more than equal, to the vast battle ships of England of 14,150 tons displacement. Our battle ships have a much heavier battery than is found upon the great English ships, and they have an equally strong protection. Moreover, they have a lower freeboard and hence do not present so much of a target as the high free-

boards of the English men-of-war. There need be no fear that these four great battle-ships when completed will fail to give a good account of themselves at any time, if, unfortunately, they should ever be compelled to render such account.

But it is not only in the construction of our ships that progress has been made. This progress is to be found in all the auxiliary features of a well-equipped naval force. Four years ago, we had no armor-piercing projectiles, nor could we produce them in this country. A battle-ship without armor-piercing projectiles would be absolutely worthless. I remember, in the difficulty that we had with Chile, which was thought at one time to be serious, the "Miantonomoh" was just being finished in your harbor; and the press of New York took great comfort from the fact that she would form a powerful element of defence if occasion required. The public didn't know the fact that we hadn't a single armor-piercing projectile to use in her ten-inch guns. We had to scurry all over Europe to find where we could purchase a hundred armor-piercing projectiles for these guns. We found them and we imported them. But before that time we had established a plant in this country for the production of armor-piercing projectiles; and to-day we are turning out these

projectiles in numbers sufficient to supply all our wants. Nowhere in the world are there better armor-piercing projectiles than we are now producing in this country.

Another and most important step was the development of the armor of our ships. When the fight between the "Monitor" and the "Merrimack" opened the eyes of the world to the importance of ironclads, the contest began between guns and armor. It was universally believed that the gun was superior to the armor; that no armor could be constructed that the gun could not destroy. Yet within the last three years we have succeeded in producing an armor entirely new to the world, which no gun, having reference to the size of the calibre and the thickness of the plate, can pierce. If you fire a projectile out of proportion to the thickness of plate, of course it can be broken and even destroyed. But considering the calibre in proportion to the plate, the Harveyized nickel steel armor is superior to the gun. That is an American product. We demonstrated, at the first public trial of armor plate in this country, the superiority of our own manufacture and the worthlessness of the so-called compound armor that has been placed upon the English ships. We demonstrated the high qualities of our armor so completely and abso-

lutely that Admiral Hopkins stated during his present visit here that England would use it in her ships.

We have thus progressed in the three great elements that go to make up naval strength : ships, projectiles and armor. Of course, gentlemen, we have not a large navy ; we shall not have a large navy when all the ships now authorized are completed. We have yet much to do. But in quality our navy can compare with the three great naval powers of Europe : England, France and Russia. We need twice as many ships as we now have. It will cost seventy millions of dollars more to build and complete a navy adequate for our defense. But that money is well expended. I need not in the presence of such an audience as this, in the City of New York, dwell for a moment upon the great importance of the protection of this harbor and of our seacoast cities by an adequate naval force. Our army is small. We never shall need a large standing army, because no power can ever successfully attack us upon the land. But a naval force adequate to the complete and absolute defence of our seacoast cities is essential to the peace and security of the nation ; and I have no doubt that the construction now going on will be pursued and followed up until we shall have such a navy as our necessities require.

I have given you, thus briefly, gentlemen, a very imperfect and slight idea of the progress that has been made in naval construction in the last four years. I trust and believe that that progress will be continued ; and that as great as our successes have been, greater success will await us until we have a navy in which all the vessels, without exception, are superior to those of the same type in any other country in the world.

The Navy of the Netherlands.

RESPONSE BY COMMANDER DE GROOT, OF THE
"VAN SPEIJK":

GENTLEMEN: As a poor speaker and a bad English speaker, I ask your indulgence if I don't respond to this toast with eloquence and fancy of speech. It is a long time since a Dutch line of battle ship sailed with brooms in the tops as a sign that we had swept all our enemies from the seas. Although we may have the pride of our ancestors, we have for the present not so much to boast of in that way; for, unhappily, Mr. Cæsar never gives us any cause to foil him in the Batavian marshes; there are in our country no Spaniards left any longer; and the English and all other seas are open now to our peaceful merchant vessels; and as our wrecks are not outside anywhere, we may enjoy all the blessings of peace and liberty conquered by our heroic ancestors. Therefore, gentlemen, it could not cause any surprise that in the long line of battle-ships which pass by the Statue of Liberty at the entrance of this harbor, the Dutch color swung at the topmast of a rather old-fashioned ship. For you see, gentlemen, as

there is no one fighting on the seas, we can't spare money for sea-going, fighting ships. But I tell you that there was no better battle-ship to recall the memory of the glorious days in which liberty was conquered by the founders of Amsterdam than is recorded of the lieutenant who has been named ; when he blew up his gun-boat because he would not surrender ; having once secured liberty we could live free. The people of our land let others fight out their own quarrels. We preferred to spend our money on railroads and canals and bridges and all such useful enterprises, to contribute to the prosperity of the people of a free and happy country. But, gentlemen, if our country were to be molested on its own coasts, or in its own harbors, the Dutch home navy would still be ready for a fight ; and with the proper means and availing of the many natural advantages which the Dutch coast offers for defence, we shall then only have to show the sterling qualities which you and all our descendants in America display in so marked a degree : your spirit of enterprise, your courage and energy, and then there will be no doubt that we shall successfully resist our assailants and our liberties will never be endangered.

Therefore, gentlemen, allow me to thank you in the name of the Dutch navy, your Society and its members, for preserving all the good

qualities of the old Dutch land, and which we shall only need in a new struggle for liberty. Be sure we shall never meet but in peace, to smoke the pipe of peace. Gentlemen of the Saint Nicholas Society, I thank you.

New Amsterdam.

RESPONSE BY VICE-PRESIDENT KING :

THE great advantage of being the last speaker is, that any little thing that may have occurred to you in the early part of the evening as being fit and well to say has been anticipated. De Peyster has told you all I could tell you about history; Bishop Potter told you all my jokes; the only way I can revenge myself is by taking the toast and using the liberty of the Dutchman, not speaking to it.

You will, therefore, not expect me to give you any long dissertation upon the science of government or its comparative enforcement in the days of the ancient Dutch in their early settlement of the island; nor of the future Dutch, whenever they may come here. If I were inclined to discourse upon government, I should hardly attempt it; for I am a man of business, and I have high authority for stating that as a man of business I belong to a class that is not considered desirable in the city government. But if I were a politician I should hesitate to make a comparison between the past and the present; for, as Mrs. Malaprop has

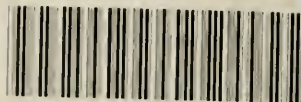
tersely and elegantly remarked, "comparisons are odorous." Like a two-edged sword they cut both ways.

I intended to have inflicted upon you this evening a very long speech, but the hour is late, and the guests are tired. I will therefore content myself with following the example of those who have gone before me, and tender in the name of the Saint Nicholas Society, to our honored guests this evening, our hearty welcome and Godspeed upon their homeward voyage.

The Society then adjourned.

At a stated meeting of the Society held on the first of June, 1893, the printing of the Record of the "VAN SPEIJK" dinner was authorized, and the publication was referred by the President to Mr. John B. Pine and Dr. T. Matlack Cheesman.

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OF THE
NEW NETHERLANDS TO THE OLD NETHERLANDS
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